The structure of cells

BACKGROUND

nucleus (say 'nu-kle-us') – the round structure at the centre of the cell containing the genetic information that controls what the cell does

cytoplasm (say 'site-o-plaz-em') – the main fluid substance inside a cell, which helps protect the cell's contents

cell membrane (say 'sell mem-brain') – the thin skin around an animal or plant cell that holds the cell together

A cell is like a tiny parcel that contains many different parts or **structures**. All types of animal and plant cells contain the following three structures:

- the nucleus
- the cytoplasm
- the cell membrane.

☞ **1** Add the missing consonants to these letters to make the names of cell structures. Use the meanings to help you.

Letters	Name	Meaning
u e u		found in the centre of the cell
e e a e		a thin skin
y o a		the jelly-like stuff inside a cell



2 Complete this passage by filling in the missing double letters. Hint: It is the same set of double letters that is missing throughout.

Both animal and plant ce __ __ s are held together by a soft ce __ __ membrane. However, plant ce __ __ s have another outer layer, called the ce __ __ wa __ __, which is made of a substance called ce __ __ ulose. These hard ce __ __ wa __ __ s give plants their shape and make them able to stand up ta __ __. Animal ce __ __ s do not have ce __ __ wa __ __ s.

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The structure of cells CONT'D

3 Choose the correct word within the brackets to complete each sentence.

a) A leaf is made up of tiny units of matter called _____. (cells / cellulose)

b) Many cells make up the _____ of human beings. (nucleus / bodies)

c) The cells of humans and animals have _____ cell walls. (hard / soft)

4 Circle the correct answer.

What are the walls of plant cells made of?

cytoplasm cellulose cells

5 Using the information in this work sheet, draw a basic diagram of a plant cell. Label the four parts described in this Activity sheet.

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